

Character Card V2 (chara_card_v2)

Character Card V2 is a specification used by AI character/chat frontends such as SillyTavern. It defines how a character's personality, prompt, scenario, examples, and metadata are stored.

Example V2 Character Card

```
{
  "spec": "chara_card_v2",
  "spec_version": "2.0",
  "data": {
    "name": "Twilight Sparkle",
    "description": "A highly intelligent and organized unicorn...",
    "personality": "Studious, curious, organized, sometimes anxious.",
    "scenario": "You are talking with Twilight in her library.",
    "first_mes": "Oh! Hello there. What can I help you with?",
    "mes_example": "<START>\n{{user}}: What are you reading?\n{{char}}: A fascinating book about ancient magic!",
    "creator_notes": "",
    "system_prompt": "",
    "post_history_instructions": "",
    "alternate_greetings": [],
    "tags": ["MLP", "Twilight Sparkle"],
    "creator": "Author name",
    "character_version": "1.0",
    "extensions": {}
  }
}
```

Important Data Fields

Field	What it does
name	Character's name
description	Main character definition - appearance, behavior, background, etc.
personality	Personality traits
scenario	Situation/world the conversation starts in
first_mes	Character's opening message
mes_example	Example conversations showing the AI how the character should talk
system_prompt	Additional system-level instructions for the character
post_history_instructions	Instructions normally injected after conversation history
alternate_greetings	Other possible starting messages
tags	Categories/search tags
creator	Person who created the card
creator_notes	Notes/instructions from the card creator
character_version	Version of this particular character
extensions	Extra application-specific information

Top-Level Fields

```
spec = "chara_card_v2"
```

```
spec_version = "2.0"
```

These tell software: "this file follows the Character Card V2 format."

Character Cards Inside PNG Files

A chara_card_v2 card does not necessarily have to look like a JSON file. A PNG character card can contain the JSON metadata embedded inside the PNG.

```
twilight_sparkle.png
```

```
an image
```

```
+
```

```
chara_card_v2 JSON character data
```

This means a single PNG can function both as the character's picture and as a container for the character definition used by compatible AI chat software.